Rongjun Ma

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Research Objective

My research focuses on everyday technology appropriation and usable security and privacy in human–AI interaction. Through empirical studies, I examine how people adopt, adapt, and integrate emerging technologies into everyday life, and how security and privacy are experienced and negotiated in human–AI interactions.

Education

Jan. 2026 – Present	**Valencian Research Institute for Artificial Intelligence, UPV** *Postdoctoral Researcher*	**Valencia, Spain**
Dec. 2020 – Aug. 2025	**Aalto University** *Doctor of Science (Technology) in Computer Science*	**Espoo, Finland**
Sept. 2018 – Sept. 2020	**European Institute of Innovation and Technology (EIT) Digital Master** *Joint master's degree in Human–Computer Interaction Design* *Entry year: Aalto University, Finland (with scholarship),* *Exit year: University of Twente, the Netherlands*	**Europe**
Sept. 2014 – June 2018	**University of Science and Technology Beijing** *Bachelor of Engineering in Internet of Things*	**Beijing, China**

Selected Publications

[1] **Rongjun Ma**, Shijing He, Jose Luis Martin-Navarro, Xiao Zhan, and Jose Such. "Privacy in Human-AI Romantic Relationships: Concerns, Boundaries, and Agency." In *Proceedings of the 2026 CHI Conference on Human Factors in Computing Systems*, pp. 1–25. 2026.

[2] **Rongjun Ma**, Joanna McGrenere, and Janne Lindqvist. "ChatGPT Sensemaking and Appropriation in Everyday Life." *Proceedings of the ACM on Human-Computer Interaction* 10, no. 6 (2026): 1–33.

[3] **Rongjun Ma**, Feng Feng, and Janne Lindqvist. "Channel Switching and Adaptive Behaviors in Multichannel Communication." *Proceedings of the ACM on Human-Computer Interaction* 9, no. 7 (2025): 1–33.

[4] **Rongjun Ma**, Caterina Maidhof, Juan Carlos Carrillo, Janne Lindqvist, and Jose Such. "Privacy Perceptions of Custom GPTs by Users and Creators." In *Proceedings of the 2025 CHI Conference on Human Factors in Computing Systems*, pp. 1–18. 2025.

[5] **Rongjun Ma**, Henrik Lassila, Leysan Nurgalieva, and Janne Lindqvist. "When Browsing Gets Cluttered: Exploring and Modeling Interactions of Browsing Clutter, Browsing Habits, and Coping." In *Proceedings of the 2023 CHI Conference on Human Factors in Computing Systems*, pp. 1–29. 2023.

[6] Shuning Zhang, Yutong Jiang, **Rongjun Ma**, Yuting Yang, Mingyao Xu, Zhixin Huang, Xin Yi, and Hewu Li. "PrivWeb: Unobtrusive and Content-Aware Privacy Protection for Web Agents." In *Proceedings of the 2026 CHI Conference on Human Factors in Computing Systems*, pp. 1–29. 2026.

[7] Yuting Yang, Zixin Wang, **Rongjun Ma**, and Florian Schaub. "Privacy and Trust vs. Utility: Adoption of Commercial vs. Institutional AI Assistants Among University Users." In *Proceedings of the 2026 CHI Conference on Human Factors in Computing Systems*, pp. 1–25. 2026.

[8] Juan-Carlos Carrillo, Jose Luis Martin-Navarro, **Rongjun Ma**, and Jose Such. "Personal Data Flows and Privacy Policy Traceability in Third-party LLM Apps in the GPT Ecosystem." *Proceedings on Privacy Enhancing Technologies* (2026).

[9] Xin Sun, **Rongjun Ma**, Shu Wei, Pablo Cesar, Jos A. Bosch, and Abdallah El Ali. "Understanding Trust Toward Human versus AI-generated Health Information through Behavioral and Physiological Sensing." *International Journal of Human-Computer Studies* (2025): 103714.

[10] Heidi Rautalahti, **Rongjun Ma**, Amel Bourdoucen, Yajing Wang, and Janne Lindqvist. "Fluid Roles for Close-Knit Gaming: Households Playing Digital Games." *Proceedings of the ACM on Human-Computer Interaction* 9, no. 6 (2025): 695–729.

[12] Doctoral thesis: **Rongjun Ma**. "Everyday Appropriation of Technology: Experiences, Challenges, and Implications." 2025.

Awards and Scholarships

Nokia Bell Labs Scholarship 2024
- Awarded scholarship for academic excellence in the Information Security track.

Doctoral Incentive Scholarship 2025

Academic Service and Guest Talks

Conference Service
- **Associate Chair:** CHI 2026, CHI 2027; CSCW 2025 Posters
- **PC member:** ICHEC 2025; PoPETS 2027
- **Reviewer:** CHI 2024–2025; CSCW 2024; SOUPS 2022, 2025 Posters
- **Volunteer:** UbiComp 2025 (Day Captain)

Invited Talk | *FSE 2025 LLMapp Workshop* Trondheim, Norway
- Invited speaker on security and privacy in LLM applications.

Guest Lecture | *Universität Siegen, 2026* Germany
- Guest lecture on human–AI relationship dynamics, communication, and privacy negotiation.

Workshop Co-organizer | *UPV, 2026* Valencia, Spain
- Co-organized a three-day workshop on security and privacy in agentic AI.

Panel Moderator | *UPV, 2026* Valencia, Spain
- Moderated an expert panel on privacy and security in agentic AI.

Teaching and Supervision

Teaching | *Research Methods in Psychology Engineering* Spring 2023
- Prepared course materials and lectured on data collection methods and research ethics.

Teaching | *Security Engineering* 2021–2022
- Prepared course materials, lectured on machine-learning-based malicious URL detection, and assessed student work.

Seminar Supervision Spring 2021
- Supervised three student projects in applied security, privacy, and computational social science.

Master's Thesis Supervision 2022, 2023
- Supervised two master's theses on browsing behavior and household gaming; the latter resulted in a peer-reviewed publication in 2025.

Research Impact and Media Coverage

Human–AI Romance Research | *CHI 2026* 2026
- First-authored research received national, international, and regional media coverage, including **RTVE (Spanish National Television)**, **EFE**, **EurekAlert!/AAAS**, and **Valencia News**.

Browsing Clutter Research | *CHI 2023* 2023
- First-authored research received international science and technology media coverage, including **Tech Xplore** and **EurekAlert!/AAAS**.

Computing Skills

Programming and technical skills: Python, React.js, machine learning, natural language processing

Research platforms: Prolific, ATLAS.ti, MAXQDA

Languages: Chinese (native), English (professional working proficiency)